

Pozole Rojo

Chile-forward · pork-rich · collagen-extracted · no shortcuts

YIELD	TIME	WATER	CHILE
4 L · 6–8	1.25 / 3.5 hr	2 L per kg pork	200 g per 4 L

TEMPERATURE TARGETS

paste fries to brick/burgundy; pork done at 195–205°F

Aromatics broil	500°F+ char	Chile toast	350–375°F
Pan browning	400–450°F	Lard for paste	375–400°F
Broth simmer	190–200°F	Pork internal	195–205°F

INGREDIENTS

2 L water per kg pork · 50 g chiles per liter

PORK & BROTH		CHILE PASTE — 200 G			HOMINY & FINISH	
Pork shoulder bone-in	2 kg	Guajillo the red	70%	140 g	Hominy 2 cans	1.6 kg
Pig's feet or 750 g neck	500 g	Ancho body, sweet	25%	50 g	Lard total	~90 g
Water	4 L	Árbol heat	5%	10 g	Apple cider vinegar	15 g
Onions quartered	2	Garlic raw		25–30 g	Salt	to taste
Garlic head halved	1	Cumin · oregano		3 · 1 g	The spread: cabbage, radish, onion, oregano, lime.	
Bay leaves	2	Salt · peppercorns		3 g · 6		

Two non-negotiables: collagen + simmer for body — blanched trotters and a lazy **190–200°F** simmer for 2.5–3 hr are what make the broth rich, not thin (**never a hard boil** — it turns the broth cloudy and greasy). Want more body? Push the trotters to **750 g–1 kg** or add pork skin. And **fry the chile paste to brick/burgundy** in shimmering lard to cook out the raw edge — guajillo-forward plus a clean brick fry is what gives the signature red.

Build the Pot

METHOD

broth 2.5–3 hr · start the paste at the 1-hour mark

- 1 **Broil:** onions quartered + garlic halved, cut-side up, 6–8" from the broiler, **8–12 min to char** (500°F+). Reserve 1 onion for the paste.
- 2 **Prep + blanch:** debone the shoulder, cube 2–3", reserve the bone. Scrub the feet, singe any stray hairs, split lengthwise. **Blanch the feet + bone:** cover with cold water, boil **5–10 min**, dump that scummy water, rinse the feet and the pot — this is what keeps the broth clean instead of funky and cloudy.
- 3 **Brown:** shimmering lard, brown the pork in 3–4 batches, 2–3 min/side, to build fond (400–450°F).
- 4 **Simmer:** add bone, collagen cuts, pork, aromatics, bay, water. **Lazy bubbles 2.5–3 hr** at 190–200°F. Skim at 30 min; start the paste at 1 hr.
- 5 **Toast:** dry skillet — árbol 15–20 sec/side, guajillo/ancho/pasilla 30–60 sec/side. Watch for the puff, then stem + seed.
- 6 **Soak:** off-boil hot water, submerge the chiles **25 min**. Reserve the liquid.
- 7 **Blend:** chiles + a cup of the liquid + the roasted onion + raw garlic + spices. **Strain hard**, rinsing with a little broth.
- 8 **Fry:** 4 spoons of lard, shimmering. Add the paste (it sizzles hard), vinegar at 30 sec, stir **3–4 min to brick/burgundy** (375–400°F).
- 9 **Bloom:** kill the heat, stir in the drained hominy, rest **15–20 min** off heat to absorb the chile-lard.
- 10 **Finish:** pork at 195–205°F → remove. Strain + skim the broth, add the chile-hominy, simmer **15 min**, return the pork 5 min. Salt; lime if flat.
- 11 **Serve:** ladle **70% broth, 30% solids**; tear the pork by hand into irregular chunks. Pass the garnishes.

TROUBLESHOOTING

better on day 2 — the fat cap makes skimming easy

PROBLEM	CAUSE	FIX
Thin broth	No collagen cuts / short simmer	Add feet or neck; simmer 2.5–3 hr min
Bitter paste	Burnt or old chiles	Toast less; a pinch of brown sugar if bitter
Brown, not red	Too much dark chile (pasilla / ancho); old or over-toasted chiles	Go guajillo-forward (~70%); glossy chiles, toast lightly
Tough pork	Under 195°F	Keep simmering — collagen breaks at 195–205°F
Flat flavor	No acid	Add lime at the end for brightness